



IIT ROORKEE



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PUBLIC SPEAKING

Lecture 37: Interviews

Prof. Binod Mishra

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



Introduction

- ❑ The term interview has its origin in the French word *entrevoir*, meaning to “see each other”.
- ❑ It functionally implies face-to-face communication between the **interviewer and interviewee**.
- ❑ Interview as a selection method employs an oral medium to assess the skill sets of candidates.
- ❑ Depending on the type of interview, the number of participants involved in an interview varies.



Purpose of the Interview

- ❑ Career development centre (CDC) of Occidental College, L.A, lists down the purpose of an interview as to address the following questions:
 - **What you have to offer** (your skills, abilities, basic knowledge).
 - **Who you are** (your personality, character, interests).
 - **Why you should be hired** (your potential).



Types of Interview

Persuasive Interview

Exit Interview

Evaluation Interview

Counselling

Conflict Resolution Interview

Disciplinary Interview

Job Interview

Termination Interview

Virtual Interview

Information Gathering Interview



Interview set-up

- ❑ Apart from the differences in the interview, with respect to its context, interviews may also vary in accordance to their physical setting:
 - One-on-one interviews
 - Group interview
 - Panel interview
 - Mealtime interview
 - Phone interview
 - Video-conference interview
 - On-the-job interview
 - Stress interview



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Points to remember for an Interview

- Display self-confidence
- Well-informed with the area concerned
- Application of the acquired knowledge
- Efficient handling of the interview environment
- Understanding the needs and expectations of the interview
- Proper use of formal language

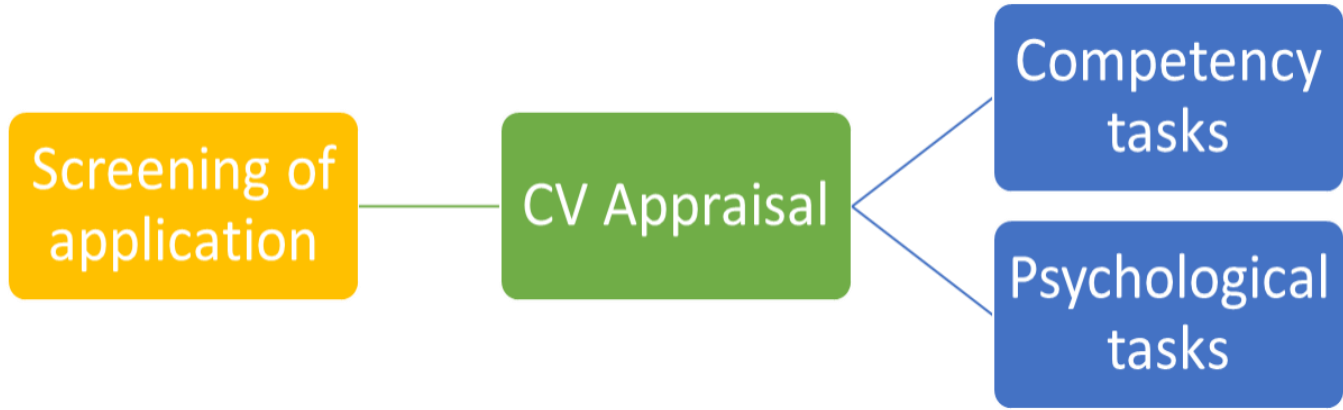


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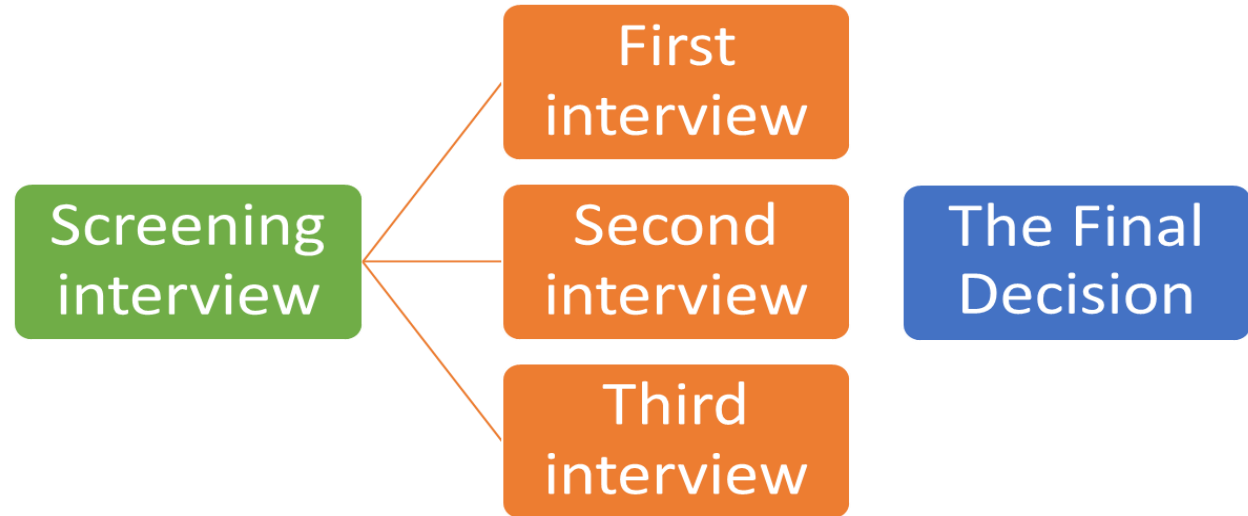
Contd...

- Recognizing one's strengths and weaknesses
- Clarity of thought and expressions
- Ability to take a spontaneous and correct decision
- Originality of ideas and approach
- Innovative mind and cheerful disposition.

Pre-interview Phase



Interview Phase



Verbal Communication during Interview

- ❖ Exchange greetings and seek permission.
- ❖ Briefly introduce yourself. Showcase your strengths.
- ❖ Wait for the questions from the interviewer. Listen actively.
- ❖ Deliver clear and concise answers without digression.
- ❖ Avoid fillers (lexical and non-lexical).
- ❖ Use professional language with standard grammar.
- ❖ Be positive and try to answer with a formal sense of humour.



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Non-verbal conversation during Interview

- ❖ Dress appropriately in a formal business tone.
- ❖ Start the interview with a firm handshake.
- ❖ Keep steady eye- contact. Establish rapport.
- ❖ Have a smile on your face. Express positive communication.
- ❖ Demonstrate strong and confident posture throughout the interview.
- ❖ Refrain from squirming and displaying your nervousness.



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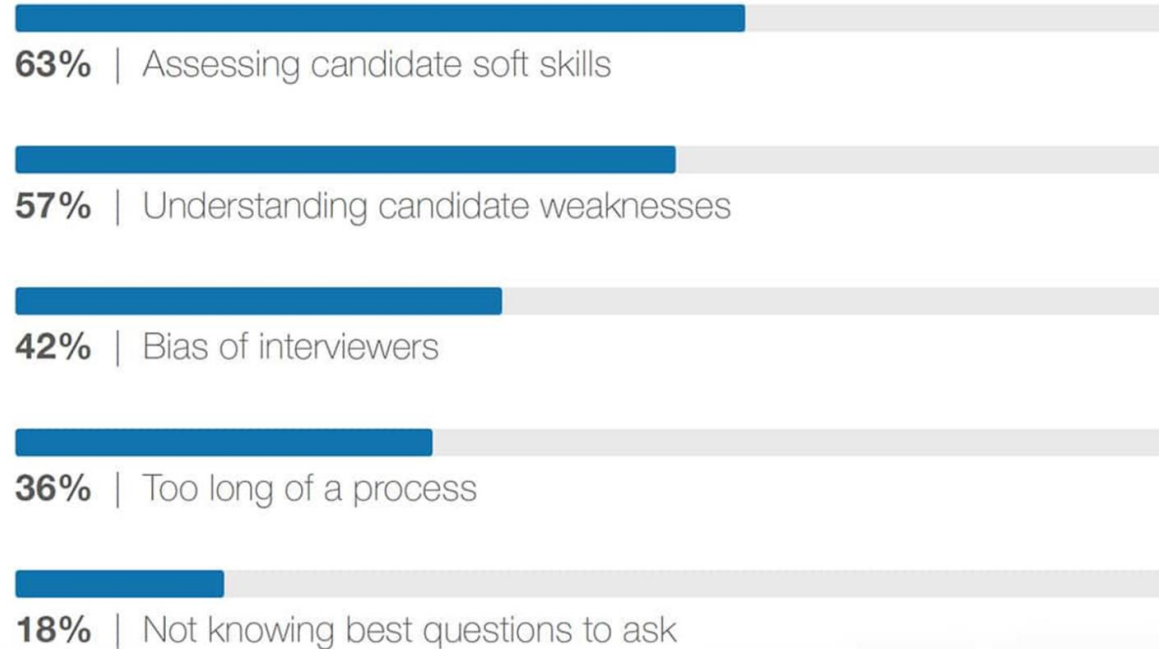
Personality Test

- Most of the interviews have a dedicated part (or a set of questions) to evaluate the personality of the interviewee:
- Personality interview seeks to evaluate **human skills** than technical or competency skills.
- Human skills include reflecting values such as:
 - Empathy.
 - Compassion
 - Motivating fellow employees
 - Decision-making
 - Leadership etc.

Advantages and Disadvantages of Interviews

Advantages	Disadvantages
Personal and deep approach.	Expensive in terms of time, space and personnel involved.
Structured yet adaptable.	Long and hefty process with a large number of participants/applicants.
Scope for improvisation with follow-ups, parallel assessments etc.	Scope for misinterpretation.
Questions can be explained better to generate appropriate responses.	Less room for evaluating soft skills and behavioural skills.
Provides better outlook towards non-verbal communication.	Interviewer bias might hamper final decision/assessment.

WHERE TRADITIONAL INTERVIEWS FAIL



LinkedIn TALENT SOLUTIONS

Source: LinkedIn 2018
Global Recruiting Trends
Report

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Interview bias

- It occurs when the interviewer judges a candidate over personal reasons/interests than following a standard rubric.
- The bias may occur due to the following:
 - Stereotypical mindset.
 - Misinterpretation of (non)verbal cues.
 - Cultural similarities/ differences.
 - First impression.
- It can be avoided by approaching all interviewees with the same set of approaches, questions and mindset.
- Employing fact-based/ objective interview session also helps to reduce interview bias.

“I want to make sure I always show off my smile and have a positive attitude the whole time, whether it's during a performance, practice, or doing an interview.”

- Laurie Hernandez, American Gymnast.



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“When one door closes, another opens; but we often look so long and so regretfully upon the closed door that we do not see the one which has opened for us.” –Alexander Graham Bell

Thank You

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